

OM NAMAH SHIVAYA

CHAR DHAM YATRA 2026

+ VASUKI TAL + SOMNATH DARSHAN

Solo Pilgrimage Roadmap
Mumbai → Yamunotri → Gangotri → Kedarnath → Vasuki Tal → Badrinath → Somnath → Mumbai
05 May 2026 – 24/25 May 2026

Traveller	Solo Pilgrim (Samaranjan Manjhi) — Age 25, Male
Train	19019 BDTS HW EXP ■ CONFIRMED Board: 4 May (Mon) 12:20 AM from Bandra Terminus Arrive: Haridwar 6 May (Wed) 7:50 AM (~31.5 hrs)
Budget	Mid-range Rs.1,000 – 2,500 / day
Trekking Mode	Walk Only (no pony / helicopter) Both bags carried always
Hotel Booking	On-site / at destination — no pre-booking
Pilgrim Registrations	Yamunotri 9 May Gangotri 12 May Kedarnath 15 May Badrinath 18 May

SECTION 1 : COMPLETE DAY-WISE ITINERARY

DAY 1 04 May (Mon) — 12:20 AM		Mumbai — Board Train 19019 ■ TICKET CONFIRMED
Plan:	TICKET CONFIRMED — Train 19019 BDTS HW EXP. Board at Bandra Terminus (BDTS) on 4 May Monday at 12:20 AM midnight. Reach station by 11:30 PM on 4 May (Monday night) to be safe. Keep ticket (physical printout + phone screenshot) and Aadhaar ready for TC check. Full journey ~31.5 hrs. Arrive Haridwar on 6 May (Wednesday) at 7:50 AM.	
Sightseeing:	N/A — On Train	
DAY 2 05 May (Tue)		On Train — Continuing to Haridwar
Plan:	Full travel day on train. Major stations: Surat, Vadodara (good food ~11 AM halt), Ratlam, Kota, Mathura, H. Nizamuddin Delhi (~2:35 AM, 15 min halt). Arrive Haridwar 6 May at 7:50 AM. Rest and conserve energy.	
Sightseeing:	N/A — On Train	
DAY 3 06 May (Wed)		Arrive Haridwar 7:50 AM — STAY: near Har Ki Pauri
Plan:	Arrive Haridwar 7:50 AM. Check in dharamshala or hotel near Har Ki Pauri (Rs.400-800). Freshen up, eat light. Afternoon rest. Evening 7 PM: Har Ki Pauri Ganga Aarti. Early sleep — long jeep ride tomorrow.	
Sightseeing:	Har Ki Pauri Ghat (2 min walk from stay), Mansa Devi Temple (15 min walk up the hill), Chandi Devi Temple (20 min walk), Birla Ghat (10 min walk along river)	
DAY 4 07 May (Thu)		Haridwar → Barkot — STAY: Barkot main market area
Plan:	Morning 6 AM: Shared jeep Haridwar → Barkot via Rishikesh + Dehradun (~170 km, 5-6 hrs, Rs.300-400). Arrive Barkot afternoon. Check in hotel near market (Rs.600-1200). Rest, acclimatise (1,220 m). Evening: light walk. Sleep early.	
Sightseeing:	Barkot market (at doorstep), Yamuna River bank (5 min walk from market), Surya Mandir Barkot (10 min walk), local tea stalls and dhaba row (2 min walk)	
DAY 5 08 May (Fri)		Barkot — Rest + Acclimatise — STAY: Barkot
Plan:	Full rest day. Body adjusts from sea level to 1,220 m. No major walking — only gentle stroll. Check gear, stock dry fruits and water. Sleep by 9 PM — 5 AM start tomorrow for Yamunotri.	
Sightseeing:	Yamuna River bank (5 min walk), Hanuman Temple near market (5 min walk), Barkot bazaar stroll (at doorstep)	
DAY 6 09 May (Sat)		YAMUNOTRI DARSHAN ■ (REGISTERED 9 MAY) — STAY: Janki Chatti
Plan:	5 AM: Shared jeep Barkot → Janki Chatti (15 km, Rs.50). Trek Janki Chatti → Yamunotri Temple = 6 km one way (3-4 hrs up, 2.5 hrs down, ~900 m gain). Darshan at Yamuna temple. Cook rice/potato in Surya Kund hot spring (tradition). Return Janki Chatti by 3 PM. Night stay Janki Chatti.	
Sightseeing:	Yamunotri Temple (the trek itself is the sightseeing), Surya Kund hot spring (at temple), Divya Shila rock pillar (5 min before temple entrance), Janki Chatti hot water kund (at stay, 5 min walk)	
DAY 7 10 May (Sun)		Janki Chatti → Uttarkashi — STAY: Uttarkashi near Vishwanath Temple
Plan:	Morning: Jeep Janki Chatti → Barkot → Uttarkashi (~115 km, 4-5 hrs, Rs.200-300). Check in hotel near Vishwanath Temple area (Rs.500-1000). Afternoon: explore town. Stock supplies for Gangotri. Confirm 12 May Gangotri registration.	

Sightseeing:	Vishwanath Temple Uttarkashi (5 min walk from hotels in that area), Shakti Temple (10 min walk from Vishwanath), Kuteti Devi Temple (15 min walk), Nehru Mountaineering Institute NMI gate (20 min walk)
---------------------	--

DAY 8 11 May (Mon)	Uttarkashi → Gangotri — STAY: near Gangotri Temple
-----------------------------	---

Plan:	Morning: Jeep Uttarkashi → Gangotri (100 km, 4 hrs, Rs.200-250). Check in dharamshala or hotel near Gangotri temple (Rs.400-800). Altitude 3,100 m — eat light. Evening aarti at Ganga temple. Rest well — darshan tomorrow.
Sightseeing:	Gangotri Temple (2 min walk from stay), Bhagirathi River bank (at temple, 1 min walk), Pandava Gufa cave (10 min walk from temple), Gauri Kund pond (15 min walk from temple)

DAY 9 12 May (Tue)	GANGOTRI DARSHAN ■ (REGISTERED 12 MAY) → STAY: Guptkashi / Sitapur
-----------------------------	---

Plan:	Morning darshan at Gangotri temple. After puja start by 10 AM — long drive day. Gangotri → Uttarkashi → Rishikesh → Rudraprayag → Guptkashi (~300 km, 9-10 hrs). Arrive Guptkashi night. Check in hotel (Rs.600-1200). Sleep immediately.
Sightseeing:	Guptkashi Vishwanath Temple (10 min walk from hotels — visit only if energy permits after long drive), Ardhnareshwar Temple Guptkashi (5 min walk from Vishwanath)

DAY 10 13 May (Wed)	Guptkashi → Kedarnath Trek — STAY: Kedarnath (3,583 m)
------------------------------	---

Plan:	5 AM: Jeep to Sonprayag (Rs.100), govt shuttle to Gaurikund (Rs.50). Gaurikund (1,982 m) → Kedarnath (3,583 m) = 16 km, ~1,600 m climb, 6-8 hrs. Rent trekking poles at Gaurikund Rs.100. Carry water + dry fruits + glucose. Check in GMVN or dharamshala at Kedarnath (Rs.500-1500). Evening aarti.
Sightseeing:	Gaurikund Tapt Kund hot spring (dip before trek start, at Gaurikund), Kedarnath Temple evening aarti (2 min from stay), Shankaracharya Samadhi (2 min behind main temple)

DAY 11 14 May (Thu)	Kedarnath — Rest Day — STAY: Kedarnath
------------------------------	---

Plan:	Full rest day at Kedarnath. Legs and body recover from 16 km climb. Morning: attend Kedarnath main temple aarti (4 AM). Afternoon: gentle walk only. Eat well — khichdi, dal available at dhabas near temple. Sleep early — darshan tomorrow at 4 AM.
Sightseeing:	Kedarnath Temple morning aarti (2 min from stay), Gandhi Sarovar small lake (30 min walk from temple), Bhairav Temple (20 min walk from main Kedarnath temple)

DAY 12 15 May (Fri)	KEDARNATH DARSHAN ■ (REGISTERED 15 MAY) + Vasuki Tal Optional — STAY: Kedarnath
------------------------------	--

Plan:	Pre-dawn 4 AM: Main Kedarnath darshan (REGISTERED 15 MAY). Abhishek, pooja complete by 8 AM. OPTION A — Rest after darshan. Stay at Kedarnath. OPTION B — Vasuki Tal same day trek (8 km one way, 4,135 m, 3 hrs up 2.5 hrs down). Start immediately after darshan. Return by 4 PM. If overnight: RENT sleeping bag Rs.150-200 at Kedarnath BEFORE going. WITHOUT sleeping bag at -5 to -8 C overnight = hypothermia risk.
Sightseeing:	Kedarnath Temple darshan (at stay), Vasuki Tal glacial lake (8 km from temple — optional trek), Gandhi Sarovar (30 min walk from temple), Shankaracharya Samadhi (2 min from temple)

DAY 13 16 May (Sat)	Kedarnath → Gaurikund → Pipalkoti — STAY: Pipalkoti
------------------------------	--

Plan:	Morning: Trek down Kedarnath → Gaurikund (16 km, 4-5 hrs downhill). Jeep Sonprayag → Rudraprayag → Pipalkoti (~150 km, 4-5 hrs). Check in hotel Pipalkoti (Rs.500-1000). Hot shower, rest legs.
Sightseeing:	Pipalkoti market (at doorstep), Alaknanda River bank Pipalkoti (10 min walk), Local Shiva temple near Pipalkoti bus stand (5 min walk)

DAY 14 17 May (Sun) Pipalkoti → Joshimath → Badrinath — STAY: Badrinath	
Plan:	Morning: Jeep Pipalkoti → Joshimath (60 km, 2 hrs). Visit Narasimha Temple Joshimath (10 min, very important). Continue Joshimath → Badrinath (45 km, 1.5 hrs). Check in dharamshala/hotel (Rs.500-1200). Evening: Tapt Kund hot spring bath, Brahma Kapal ghat. Badrinath altitude 3,133 m.
Sightseeing:	Badrinath Temple evening darshan (2 min from stay), Tapt Kund hot spring (5 min walk from temple), Brahma Kapal sacred ghat (5 min walk from temple), Narad Kund (10 min walk from temple)
DAY 15 18 May (Mon) BADRINATH DARSHAN ■ (REGISTERED 18 MAY) → STAY: Rishikesh / Haridwar	
Plan:	Pre-dawn 4:30 AM: Badrinath darshan (REGISTERED 18 MAY). Tapt Kund bath before entry. Darshan complete by 9 AM. Start return: Badrinath → Rishikesh (~300 km, 9-10 hrs). Night halt Rishikesh or Haridwar.
Sightseeing:	Mana Village (3 km from Badrinath temple — last Indian village, 45 min walk one way, visit before darshan or after), Laxman Jhula Rishikesh (if staying Rishikesh — 10 min walk from Ram Jhula area hotels)
DAY 16 19 May (Tue) Rishikesh Rest + Depart for Ahmedabad — STAY: Train	
Plan:	Morning: Rishikesh — Ram Jhula, Laxman Jhula area walk. Afternoon: Board Haridwar → Ahmedabad train (Ahmedabad Express 19031, check IRCTC). ~16-17 hrs journey. Night on train.
Sightseeing:	Ram Jhula (10 min walk from Rishikesh hotels near Jhula area), Laxman Jhula (15 min walk from Ram Jhula), Triveni Ghat (10 min walk from Jhula area)
DAY 17 20 May (Wed) Travel — On Train to Ahmedabad — STAY: Ahmedabad	
Plan:	Arrive Ahmedabad morning. Check in hotel near Kalupur station (Rs.600-1000). Rest, freshen up. Afternoon free.
Sightseeing:	Kalupur Swaminarayan Temple (5 min walk from Kalupur station), Bhadra Fort area (15 min walk from station), Teen Darwaza gate (15 min walk)
DAY 18 21 May (Thu) Ahmedabad → Somnath — STAY: near Somnath Temple	
Plan:	Morning: Sabarmati Ashram visit (free, 1 hr — 20 min auto from station). Afternoon: Board Ahmedabad → Somnath train/bus (~7-8 hrs). Arrive Somnath evening. Check in hotel near temple (Rs.700-1500).
Sightseeing:	Somnath Temple area (2 min walk from hotels near temple), Triveni Sangam Somnath (10 min walk from temple — 3 rivers meet here), Suraj Mandir Sun Temple (15 min walk from Somnath temple)
DAY 19 22 May (Fri) SOMNATH DARSHAN — STAY: near Somnath Temple	
Plan:	Morning 6 AM: Somnath Jyotirlinga darshan — 1st of 12 Jyotirlingas. Very significant. Attend all 3 aartis: 7 AM, 12 PM, 7 PM. Sound and light show 8 PM — spectacular, must attend. Evening: Book return train to Mumbai at Somnath / Veraval station.
Sightseeing:	Somnath Temple (at stay, 2 min walk), Triveni Sangam (10 min walk), Suraj Mandir Sun Temple (15 min walk), Prabhas Patan Museum (15 min walk), Bhalka Tirth — where Lord Krishna was struck by arrow (20 min walk from temple)
DAY 20 23 May (Sat) Somnath → Mumbai — Yatra Complete ■	
Plan:	Morning: One last darshan at Somnath. Board Somnath → Mumbai train (Somnath Bandra Express 22956 or Veraval–Mumbai train). Journey ~11-13 hrs. Arrive Mumbai 24 May morning. Rest 1-2 days after return. Distribute prasad to family. Yatra complete.
Sightseeing:	Somnath Temple morning darshan (at stay — final darshan before departure)

SECTION 2 : COMPLETE PACKING LIST — WHAT GOES IN WHICH BAG

NOTE: YOUR 2 BAGS: (1) Walker 65L Rucksack — on your BACK always. (2) Cross Body Sling Bag — on your FRONT/SIDE always. Both bags carried together at all times. Never leave any bag behind. Target total weight: 14-16 kg max. [MANDATORY] = Must carry no exceptions. [OPTIONAL] = Good to have but can skip to save weight.

BAG 1 : 65L Walker Rucksack (Target: 10-12 kg)

UPPER BODY CLOTHING

Item	Qty	Where to Wear	Priority
Dry-fit Trekking T-Shirt	3	Base layer on trek days. Layer under jacket in cold.	[MANDATORY]
Thermal Inner Top	1	Skin layer at 3000m+ altitude. Wear under t-shirt.	[MANDATORY]
Woollen / Fleece Sweater	1	Mid layer. Kedarnath, Gangotri, Badrinath evenings 0-5 C.	[MANDATORY]
Waterproof Rain Jacket / Windcheater	1	Outermost shell. Blocks wind + rain. Life saver at 3500m+.	[MANDATORY — No exceptions]
Kurta (Cotton/Linen)	3	Temple darshan only. Saffron or white preferred.	[MANDATORY — You already have]

LOWER BODY CLOTHING

Item	Qty	Notes	Priority
Trekking Trousers / Cargo Pants	2	1 wear + 1 dry. Quick dry fabric. NO jeans — heavy when wet.	[MANDATORY]
Thermal Inner Bottom	1	Wear under trousers at Kedarnath, Gangotri, Vasuki Tal night.	[MANDATORY]
Pyjama (Bottom for Kurta sets)	3	Temple darshan. Also doubles as night wear.	[MANDATORY — You already have]
Underwear (Quick dry)	4-5	Change daily. Quick dry cotton or synthetic.	[MANDATORY]
Trekking Socks — Thick Woollen	3 pairs	For trek days and cold nights. Layer over thin socks.	[MANDATORY]
Socks — Thin Cotton	2 pairs	Under woollen socks or for warm valley days.	[MANDATORY]
Gumboots / Waterproof Shoe Cover	—	Rent at Gaurikund Rs.50 — muddy trail option.	[OPTIONAL — Rent on spot]

HEAD, HANDS & FEET

Item	Qty	Notes	Priority
Woollen Cap / Monkey Cap	1	Covers ears. Wear every night at Kedarnath + Badrinath. -2 to -5 C at night.	[MANDATORY]
Woollen Gloves / Fleece Gloves	1 pair	Vasuki Tal has snow in May. Hands go numb fast at 4135m.	[MANDATORY]
Trekking Shoes (Ankle support, waterproof)	1 pair	Most critical item of entire trip. Break in 2 weeks before 5 May.	[MANDATORY]

Sandals / Chappals (rubber)	1 pair	Compulsory inside ALL temples. Carry in top of rucksack for easy access.	[MANDATORY]
Sunglasses (UV400 / Polarised)	1	High altitude UV is extremely harsh above 3000m. Protects eyes.	[MANDATORY]
Gamcha / Dupatta / Stole	2	Temple covering, impromptu towel, neck scarf in cold, head wrap in sun.	[MANDATORY]
Trekking Gaiters	1 pair	Snow on Vasuki Tal trail in May. Keeps snow out of shoes.	[OPTIONAL — buy Rs.300]

SLEEPING & OVERNIGHT GEAR

Item	Qty	Notes	Priority
Sleeping Bag (-5 C rated)	1	You do NOT own one. OPTIONS: Buy in Haridwar/Rishikesh Rs.800-1500 OR rent at Kedarnath base Rs.150-200/night. For Vasuki Tal overnight: WITHOUT sleeping bag = hypothermia risk at -5 to -8 C. NEVER stay overnight at 4135m without one.	[MANDATORY if overnight Vasuki Tal] [OPTIONAL if same-day trek]
Fleece Liner / Thin Blanket	1	Dharamshala blankets are often thin and smelly. A fleece liner keeps you warm and clean. Lightweight 300g. Rs.200-400.	[RECOMMENDED]
Microfibre Towel (quick dry)	1	Small, lightweight, dries in 1 hr. Hotels above 3000m rarely provide towels.	[MANDATORY]

PUJA / SPIRITUAL ITEMS

Item	Qty	Notes	Priority
Aarti Thali (small metal plate)	1	For offerings. Fold a leaf plate if too heavy.	[OPTIONAL]
Dhoop / Incense sticks	1 small pack	Available at every temple — buy fresh at each dham.	[OPTIONAL — buy locally]
Camphor / Kapoor (small box)	1	For aarti. Very light. Rs.20.	[MANDATORY]
Rudraksha Mala	1	For japa on train, during treks.	[MANDATORY — spiritual]
Chandan / Sandalwood paste tube	1	Small tube Rs.30. Tilak at temples.	[OPTIONAL]
Gangajal bottle (small)	1	Fill at Har Ki Pauri Haridwar on Day 3. Carry throughout.	[MANDATORY]
Red/Yellow cloth (vastra)	2 small	Offering at Kedarnath. Buy in Haridwar.	[MANDATORY]
Kalava / Sacred red thread	2 rolls	Given at temples too but carry your own. Very light.	[OPTIONAL]
Prasad: Misri, Batasha	250g	Buy in Haridwar market. Light and sacred.	[OPTIONAL]

TREK GEAR & UTILITIES (in 65L rucksack top section)

Item	Qty	Notes	Priority
Trekking Poles / Walking Stick	1-2	Rent at Gaurikund Rs.100 or buy bamboo stick en route. MUST for 16 km Kedarnath climb.	[MANDATORY — rent or buy]

Backpack Rain Cover (or 2 garbage bags)	2	Line inside both bags with garbage bags. Rain hits suddenly above 3000m.	[MANDATORY]
Laundry Soap bar (Rin / Surf)	1 small	Hand wash clothes overnight at hotels. Reuse next day.	[MANDATORY]
Zip-lock bags (medium)	10	Waterproof your documents, phone, cash, medicines inside bags.	[MANDATORY]
Garbage bags (small)	5	Pack in pack out. Keep mountains clean.	[MANDATORY]
Needle + thread (small sewing kit)	1	Stitch torn bag strap, fix clothing on road.	[OPTIONAL]
Ear plugs	1 pair	Dharamshalas are noisy. Helps you sleep for early 4 AM starts.	[OPTIONAL]

BAG 2 : Cross Body Sling Bag (Target: 4-5 kg — daily use items + quick access)

DOCUMENTS & MONEY (always in sling bag, never in rucksack)

Item	Qty	Notes	Priority
Aadhaar Card ORIGINAL	1	Mandatory at every Char Dham check post + hotel check-in. Keep in zip-lock.	[MANDATORY]
Aadhaar Photocopies	3	Give copy at checkposts, keep original safe.	[MANDATORY]
All 4 Char Dham Reg. Printouts	4	Yamunotri 9 May / Gangotri 12 May / Kedarnath 15 May / Badrinath 18 May. Keep all 4 together.	[MANDATORY]
Train Ticket (print + phone screenshot)	1	Train 19019 BDTS HW EXP, 4 May 12:20 AM Bandra Terminus.	[MANDATORY]
Passport Size Photos	6	Asked at some temple registrations and hotel check-ins.	[MANDATORY]
Cash — Daily Use	Rs.5,000-8,000	Keep in sling bag for daily jeeps, food, hotels.	[MANDATORY]
Cash — Emergency Hidden	Rs.3,000-5,000	Fold in paper, keep in separate inner pocket of sling bag.	[MANDATORY]
Emergency Contact List (paper)	1	Written by hand. Family + 2 friends numbers. Phone can die.	[MANDATORY]
Small Notebook + Pen	1	Hotel addresses, contact numbers, notes.	[MANDATORY]
Travel Insurance (policy number noted)	—	Note policy number + helpline in notebook.	[OPTIONAL but recommended]

PHONE + ELECTRONICS (sling bag front pocket)

Item	Qty	Notes	Priority
Smartphone	1	BSNL / Airtel SIM recommended — best hill coverage. Download offline maps BEFORE leaving Mumbai.	[MANDATORY]
Phone Charger + Cable	1	Charge every single night without fail.	[MANDATORY]
Power Bank (20,000 mAh)	1	No charging above Gaurikund on trek. Power bank is your lifeline for 2-3 days.	[MANDATORY]

Power Bank charging cable	1	Keep separate from phone cable.	[MANDATORY]
Earphones	1	Music on train (31.5 hr journey). Also useful for calls in noisy dharamshalas.	[OPTIONAL]
Headlamp / Head Torch + batteries	1	Pre-dawn 4 AM darshan queues. Power cuts at Kedarnath/Gangotri. Keep here for quick access.	[MANDATORY]
Extra batteries (AAA)	4	For headlamp. Dead batteries at 3500m = dangerous.	[MANDATORY]

WATER + FOOD (sling bag for trek days)

Item	Qty	Notes	Priority
Water Bottle (1 litre, steel/BPA free)	1	Refill at springs, taps, restaurants on trail. 1 bottle is enough — streams are frequent.	[MANDATORY]
Water Purification Tablets — Aquatabs	1 strip (10 tabs)	Drop 1 tablet in 1L water, wait 30 min. Kills all bacteria/virus. Use if only stream water available above Gaurikund.	[MANDATORY]
Water Purification Tablets — Iodine tabs	1 strip	Backup option. WaterGuard / Potable Aqua brand. Available in Rishikesh trekking shops.	[OPTIONAL — backup]
ORS Sachets (Electral / Enerzal)	8-10	Dissolve in 1L water. Drink on all trek days. Prevents dehydration at altitude.	[MANDATORY]
Dry Fruits Mix (almonds, cashew, raisins, dates)	500g	Trek energy. Split into daily small zip-lock pouches.	[MANDATORY]
Glucose / Energy Biscuits (Parle G / Tiger)	4-5 packs	Cheap, light, effective energy on climb.	[MANDATORY]
Jaggery / Gud blocks	200g	Traditional trek energy. Better than chocolate at high altitude. Wrap in foil.	[MANDATORY]
Electrolyte powder sachets (Enerzal)	8	Add to water on trek days. Prevents cramps.	[MANDATORY]
Chocolate bars	4-5	Morale food + quick energy at top of trek.	[OPTIONAL]
Chyawanprash sachet packs	10	Immunity booster. Eat 1 sachet every morning.	[RECOMMENDED]
Instant Oats / Poha sachets	5	Breakfast when hotel food not available early morning.	[OPTIONAL]

MEDICINES & FIRST AID (sling bag — always accessible)

NOTE: You mentioned NO altitude sickness history. Still carry Diamox as emergency backup — altitude affects everyone differently above 3500m. Consult doctor in Mumbai before leaving for Diamox prescription.

Medicine	Qty	Purpose	Priority
Paracetamol 500mg (Crocin/Calpol)	15 tabs	Fever, headache, body ache. Most used medicine on trek.	[MANDATORY]
Ibuprofen 400mg / Combiflam	10 tabs	Muscle pain, joint pain after 16 km Kedarnath climb.	[MANDATORY]
ORS Sachets (Electral)	10	Dehydration, loose motions, vomiting. Take immediately.	[MANDATORY]

Avomine / Vomikind tabs	6 tabs	Motion sickness on winding mountain roads. Take 30 min before jeep.	[MANDATORY]
Betadine Antiseptic Solution (small)	1 bottle	Clean blisters, cuts, wounds from trekking.	[MANDATORY]
Bandage (crepe + regular)	2 each	Knee support on descent. Blister dressing.	[MANDATORY]
Band-Aid / Adhesive plasters	10	Small cuts and blisters on feet from trekking shoes.	[MANDATORY]
Moov / Volini Pain Spray	1 small	Apply on knees and calf muscles every night after trek.	[MANDATORY]
Norflex 400mg / Ciprofloxacin	5 tabs	Stomach infection / food poisoning. Take only if severe loose motions.	[MANDATORY — use only if needed]
Diamox 250mg (Acetazolamide)	6 tabs	Altitude sickness EMERGENCY only. Start 1 tab/day from Day 8. Even with no history — 3500m+ can affect anyone.	[MANDATORY — get prescription]
Crocin Cold & Flu	6 tabs	Cold + fever from rain/cold exposure in hills.	[MANDATORY]
Clotrimazole antifungal cream	1 small tube	Fungal infection from wet socks during multi-day trek. Apply between toes.	[MANDATORY]
Sunscreen SPF 50+ (small tube)	1	Apply every morning. UV at 3000-4000m is 3x stronger than sea level.	[MANDATORY]
Lip Balm with SPF	1	Lips crack and bleed at high altitude. Use daily.	[MANDATORY]
Micropore tape / medical tape	1 roll	Wrap blisters before they form. Pre-tape toes on trek days.	[MANDATORY]
Scissors (small)	1	Cutting bandage, tape, thread.	[MANDATORY]
Safety pins	5	Emergency clothing repairs.	[OPTIONAL]
Insect Repellent cream / spray (Odomos)	1 small	Forests near Haridwar and Rishikesh. Valley areas at dusk.	[MANDATORY]
Hand Sanitiser 100ml	1	Before eating on trek. Public toilet areas.	[MANDATORY]
Toilet Paper roll (small)	1	Public toilets above Gaurikund are basic. Carry always.	[MANDATORY]

PERSONAL HYGIENE & MISC (sling bag)

Item	Qty	Notes	Priority
Toothbrush + Toothpaste (small)	1 each	Small travel size. Refill toothpaste at towns.	[MANDATORY]
Small soap bar / body wash sachet	3-4	Bathing at hotels. Also double as laundry soap backup.	[MANDATORY]
Face wash sachet	5	Dust and pollution from mountain roads. Keep face clean.	[OPTIONAL]
Moisturiser (small tube)	1	Dry mountain air cracks skin. Apply daily.	[OPTIONAL]
Comb / Hair brush	1 small	Basic grooming.	[OPTIONAL]
Nail cutter	1	Toenails must be trimmed SHORT before Kedarnath trek. Long nails cause serious toe pain going downhill.	[MANDATORY — trim before trip]

Small mirror	1	Emergency signalling + grooming.	[OPTIONAL]
--------------	---	----------------------------------	------------

NOTE: VASUKI TAL OVERNIGHT REMINDER: If you decide to stay overnight at Vasuki Tal (4135m) — temperature drops to -5 to -8 C. RENT a sleeping bag at Kedarnath base (Rs.150-200/night) before going up. Wear all layers together: thermal + kurta pyjama + fleece + rain jacket + cap + double socks + gloves. Use your rucksack under your legs as ground insulation. WITHOUT sleeping bag = serious hypothermia risk alone at 4135m. Safer choice = same day trek from Kedarnath, return by 3 PM.

SECTION 3 : ACCOMMODATION GUIDE — WHERE TO STAY & HOW MANY NIGHTS

Book on-site at each destination — no pre-booking needed in May. Mid-range budget Rs.500-1500/night. Walk in, check room, negotiate if needed.

Location	Date	Nights	Where to Look	Price & Tips
HARIDWAR	6 May (Wed)	1 Night Check-in: 7:50 AM Check-out: 7 May	Har Ki Pauri area — Upper Road, Station Road. UP Devasthanam dharamshala, GMVN.	Rs.400-800. Rooms plentiful. Drop bags, freshen up. Evening Ganga aarti 7 PM.
BARKOT	7 May (Thu)	2 Nights Check-in: 7 May Check-out: 9 May	Main bazaar near bus stand. 5-6 guesthouses available.	Rs.500-1000. Tell owner you need 5 AM start on Day 2 (9 May Yamunotri). Day 2 is rest/acclimatise day.
JANKI CHATTI (optional)	9 May (Sat)	1 Night (only if tired after trek)	Base of Yamunotri trek. Basic lodges near trek start.	Rs.300-600. Cold water only. Stay here only if too tired to return to Barkot after 6 km trek.
UTTARKAS HI	10 May (Sun)	1 Night Check-in: 10 May Check-out: 11 May	Near Vishwanath Temple / Bus Stand area.	Rs.600-1200. Hot water available. Good food. Stock all supplies for Gangotri here.
GANGOTRI	11 May (Mon)	1 Night Check-in: 11 May Check-out: 12 May	Near Gangotri temple / Bhagirathi river road.	Rs.400-900. Altitude 3100m — blanket check mandatory. Darshan is 12 May morning.
GUPTKASHI or SITAPUR	12 May (Tue)	1 Night Check-in: late night Check-out: 13 May	Near Vishwanath Mandir Guptkashi or Sitapur main road.	Rs.600-1200. Arrive late night after long drive. Sleep immediately. 5 AM start next day for Kedarnath.
KEDARNATH	13 May (Wed)	2 Nights Check-in: 13 May evening Check-out: 16 May morning	GMVN Tourist Rest House or temple camp area. Book as soon as you arrive.	GMVN Rs.700-1500. Tented camps Rs.500-800. Very cold (0 to -5 C). Night 1 = rest after trek. Night 2 = before darshan. Night 3 possible if Vasuki Tal overnight.
PIPALKOTI	16 May (Sat)	1 Night Check-in: 16 May Check-out: 17 May	NH7 highway, main market area.	Rs.500-1000. Hot shower available after 3 days at Kedarnath. Good food. Rest legs here.
BADRINATH	17 May (Sun)	2 Nights Check-in: 17 May Check-out: 19 May	Near Badrinath temple / Alaknanda river. GMVN or private hotels.	Rs.500-1500. Night 1 = explore Mana Village + rest. Night 2 = darshan is 18 May morning. Depart after darshan 18 May.

RISHIKESH or HARIDWAR	18 May (Mon)	1 Night Check-in: 18 May night Check-out: 19 May	Rishikesh — Laxman Jhula area. Haridwar — Har Ki Pauri area.	Rs.500-1200. Arrive late night after Badrinath drive. Depart for Ahmedabad 19 May afternoon.
AHMEDABA D	20 May (Wed)	1 Night Check-in: 20 May morning Check-out: 21 May	Near Kalupur Railway Station / Lal Darwaza area.	Rs.600-1000. Transit stay only. Morning Sabarmati Ashram visit. Evening depart for Somnath.
SOMNATH	21 May (Thu)	2 Nights Check-in: 21 May evening Check-out: 23 May	Near Somnath temple / Prabhas Patan road. GTDC hotel or dharamshala.	GTDC Rs.800-1500, Dharamshala Rs.200-400. Night 1 = rest. Night 2 = attend all aartis including 8 PM light show.

NOTE: TIP: Always ask 'garam paani hai?' (is hot water available?) before checking in. Nights at Kedarnath (3583m) and Badrinath (3133m) are very cold in May — confirm blanket count. Kedarnath: carry your own fleece liner. Total accommodation nights on trip: approx 18-20 nights.

SECTION 4 : TRANSPORT ROAD MAP

Mumbai → Haridwar (YOUR CONFIRMED TRAIN ■)

Train Name	No.	From	To	Duration	Days
BDTS HW EXP ■ CONFIRMED	19019	Bandra Terminus (BDTS)	Haridwar (HW)	~31.5 hrs	Depart 4 May 12:20 AM — Arrive 6 May 7:50 AM
Yoga Express	12057	CSMT Mumbai	Haridwar / Dehradun	~28 hrs	Daily — alternate option only
Uttaranchal Express	19165	LTT Mumbai	Haridwar	~30 hrs	Wed, Sat — alternate option only

NOTE: YOUR TICKET IS CONFIRMED ■ — Train 19019 BDTS HW EXP. Reach Bandra Terminus by 11:30 PM on 3 May (Sunday night). Board 4 May Monday at 12:20 AM. Arrive Haridwar 6 May Wednesday 7:50 AM. Keep ticket physical printout + screenshot on phone. Carry Aadhaar as ID proof on train.

In-Hills Transport (All Shared Jeep / Bus)

Route	Mode	Approx Cost	Time
Haridwar → Barkot	Shared jeep / bus via Dehradun + Barkot	Rs. 300-400	5-6 hrs
Barkot → Janki Chatti	Shared jeep	Rs. 50	45 min
Barkot → Uttarkashi	Shared bus / jeep	Rs. 200	3-4 hrs
Uttarkashi → Gangotri	Shared jeep	Rs. 200-250	4 hrs
Gangotri → Guptkashi	Multiple jeeps via Uttarkashi + Rishikesh + Rudraprayag	Rs. 500-700	9-10 hrs
Guptkashi → Sonprayag	Shared jeep	Rs. 80-100	1.5 hrs
Sonprayag → Gaurikund	Govt shuttle only	Rs. 50	30 min
Gaurikund → Guptkashi	Shared jeep	Rs. 80-100	1.5 hrs
Guptkashi → Joshimath	Shared jeep via Chamoli	Rs. 250-300	4-5 hrs
Joshimath → Badrinath	Shared jeep	Rs. 100-150	1.5-2 hrs
Badrinath → Rishikesh	Direct shared jeep / GMOU bus	Rs. 400-500	9-10 hrs
Haridwar → Ahmedabad	Train (Haridwar-Ahmedabad Express 19031)	Rs. 400-600 (SL class)	~17 hrs
Ahmedabad → Somnath	Train (Somnath Express 22955 / bus)	Rs. 200-350	7-8 hrs
Somnath → Mumbai	Somnath-Bandra Express 22956 or Veraval-LTT Express	Rs. 350-550 (SL)	11-13 hrs

SECTION 4B : PANCH PRAYAG SANGAM — ON YOUR ROUTE

[OPTIONAL]

All 5 Panch Prayag sacred sangams (river confluences) fall directly on your route between Rishikesh and Badrinath on NH7. No extra transport needed — just ask your state bus driver or shared jeep driver to stop for 10-15 minutes at each point. Say: 'Yahan thoda rokna' (please stop here briefly). Taking a holy dip is believed to wash away sins. Each stop is FREE.

NOTE: SOLO TRANSPORT TIP: All sangams are on NH7 state highway. State buses (GMOU/Uttarakhand Roadways) and shared jeeps between Rishikesh, Rudraprayag, Karnaprayag, Chamoli, Joshimath and Badrinath pass every sangam. You can stop, take dip, catch next bus/jeep within 30 min. Do NOT swim at Vishnuprayag — current is dangerously strong.

Sangam	Rivers Meeting	Your Day & Route	How to Stop (Solo)	Significance
1. DEVPRA YAG (Most Sacred)	Alaknanda + Bhagirathi → Ganga born here	Day 9 (12 May) Gangotri → Guptkashi via NH7	State bus Rishikesh → Rudraprayag stops at Devprayag. Ask driver. 10 min stop. Steps go down to sangam.	Holiest of all 5. Bhagirathi (from YOUR Gangotri) meets Alaknanda to form Ganga. Raghunath Temple at sangam.
2. RUDRAPRA YAG	Alaknanda + Mandakini (from Kedarnath)	Day 9 (12 May) Return via Rudraprayag Also Day 13 (16 May)	Major junction town — all buses/jeeps stop here. Easy 5 min walk from bus stand to sangam ghat.	Named after Rudra (Shiva). Mandakini flows from Kedarnath — same river you trekked beside. Koteswar Shiva temple nearby.
3. KARNAPRA YAG	Alaknanda + Pindar River	Day 13 (16 May) Pipalkoti → Badrinath via NH7	All jeeps Pipalkoti → Chamoli pass through. Ask stop. Uma Devi Temple at confluence.	Where Karna of Mahabharata worshipped Sun God. Swami Vivekananda meditated here.
4. NANDPRAY AG	Alaknanda + Nandakini River	Day 13 (16 May) Karnaprayag → Chamoli via NH7	21 km after Karnaprayag on NH7. Ask shared jeep to stop. Gopalji Temple right at sangam.	Named after King Nanda (foster father of Lord Krishna). Quiet and peaceful — less crowded than other prayags.
5. VISHNUPRA YAG	Alaknanda + Dhauliganga River	Day 14 (17 May) Joshimath → Badrinath 12 km before Badrinath	Joshimath → Badrinath jeep passes right by. Ask stop. View from bridge/road. DO NOT enter water — dangerous current.	1889 octagonal temple built by Maharani Ahilyabai. Sage Narada meditated here. Vishnu Kund pool nearby.
BONUS: KESHAV PRAYAG (6th hidden prayag)	Alaknanda + Saraswati River (disappears here)	Day 14 (17 May) Mana Village 3 km from Badrinath	You are already visiting Mana Village! Walk to Bhim Pul — Saraswati river meets Alaknanda here and disappears underground.	Most tourists miss this. The mythological Saraswati river (from Sapta Rishi) joins Alaknanda and vanishes into earth. Extremely rare sight.

NOTE: COMPLETE PANCH PRAYAG ORDER on your route (Haridwar → Badrinath direction): Devprayag (Day 9) → Rudraprayag (Day 9 & 13) → Karnaprayag (Day 13) → Nandprayag (Day 13) → Vishnuprayag (Day 14) → Keshav Prayag at Mana Village (Day 14). You cover all 5 official + 1 bonus prayag in your existing journey — no extra cost, no detour!

SECTION 5 : ESTIMATED BUDGET (Mid-Range, Solo)

Expense Head	Estimated Amount
Transport — Mumbai to Mumbai (all trains + local)	Rs. 4,000 – 6,000
Local jeeps / buses (in hills, 20 days)	Rs. 2,500 – 3,500
Accommodation (20 nights avg Rs.700/night)	Rs. 12,000 – 15,000
Food (avg Rs.400/day x 20 days)	Rs. 7,000 – 9,000
Temple donation / prasad / puja samagri	Rs. 2,000 – 3,000
Medicines + First Aid kit	Rs. 1,500 – 2,000
Trekking gear (poles on rent, gumboots, etc.)	Rs. 500 – 1,000
Miscellaneous (SIM recharge, chai, tips, etc.)	Rs. 1,500 – 2,500
TOTAL ESTIMATED	Rs. 31,000 – 42,000

NOTE: Carry Rs.20,000 cash from Mumbai. ATMs in Rishikesh and Haridwar are the last reliable cash points. Some temples accept online UPI but don't depend on it. Keep Rs.5000 in emergency stash (sock/inner pocket).

SECTION 6 : IMPORTANT TIPS FOR SOLO TREKKER

Registration is MANDATORY

Char Dham Yatra registration (chardhamregistration.uk.gov.in) is compulsory. Carry printout/screenshot of all 4. You will be checked at entry points.

Weather at High Altitude

May brings sunshine but sudden snowfall/rain above 3500m is common. NEVER ignore your rain jacket. Start treks early (5-6 AM) to avoid afternoon clouds.

Altitude Sickness

Headache, nausea, breathlessness above 3000m = AMS warning. If symptoms worsen, descend immediately. Do NOT push through. Rest, hydrate, take Diamox as advised.

Water

Do NOT drink directly from streams without purification tablets. Buy sealed water at towns. Carry your own water for treks.

Phone Signal

BSNL / Airtel has best coverage in hills. Jio is patchy. Uttarkashi, Gangotri, Kedarnath, Badrinath have basic signal but expect blackouts. Download offline maps.

Solo Safety

Tell your hotel owner your trek plan each day. Share live location with family. Register with local police post (some areas require it). Do not trek after 4 PM in unknown terrain.

Group Travel

At dharamshalas and temple queues you will naturally meet fellow pilgrims. Keep open to forming informal groups for safety and splitting jeep costs.

Temple Etiquette

Remove footwear outside temple premises. Avoid leather items inside sacred areas. No photography inside sanctum. Maintain silence during darshan.

Food

Eat vegetarian throughout yatra — your body and the tradition both benefit. Dal, rice, sabzi, roti are available everywhere. Avoid raw salads above 3000m.

Vasuki Tal Trek

This is a difficult add-on from Kedarnath (8 km each way, 4135 m). Do it ONLY if weather is clear, you rested well, and you feel strong after Kedarnath darshan. Snow possible — gaiters helpful.

Return Journey Flexibility

You have May 24-25 as return window. Somnath to Mumbai trains have decent availability. Book return train from Somnath at Somnath station on Day 18 evening.

**JAI SHREE RAM | JAI KEDARNATH | JAI BADRINATH | JAI GANGA MATA |
JAI SOMNATH**

Have a safe, blessed and memorable Yatra!

Prepared by Samaranjan Manjhi | Itinerary based on May 2026 pilgrim schedule